

The Pentagon prefers Android for military use

It's not the makers of smartphones or tablets alone that prefer Android over other platforms. The operating system from Google has also been picked up by the Pentagon, the headquarters of the US Department of Defence. Sources have confirmed that an Android version will run on Dell hardware. It has been reported that apart from encrypted BlackBerry networks, the Pentagon will also have Android functioning but with some conditions as it is open source.

The first Android gaming tablet—the JXD S7100

A company named JingXing has rolled out an Android-based gaming tablet—the JXD S7100, which is poised to compete against Sony Ericsson's Xperia PLAY. Unlike the latter, JXD S7100 is not a smartphone but a tablet device.

The tablet runs on Android 2.2 and features a four-way D-pad.

Specs of the tablet include a 17.8-cm (7-inch) display with an 800x480 resolution, a capacitive touch-screen, an ARM Cortex A9 CPU and Mali 400 Graphics Core processor. The tablet has 512 MB of RAM, 16 GB of internal storage, and comes equipped with a 2 mega-pixel back camera, a VGA 0.3 MP front-facing camera, and HDMI out. It is priced at \$140.

The device is equipped with a complete set of gaming control pads, four control buttons (circle, triangle, square, x), a start and select button, and on-screen controls. This gaming tablet offers a variety of touch-screen games like the Arcade, Sony PS1, Samurai II, Ninja Rush, Asphalt 5, Wave Blazer, Metal Slug, Mario Kart 64, Angry Birds, Plants Vs Zombies and Fruit Ninja HD. It also has a games centre and an apps centre.



MIT students can now read IIT content!

Now, the students of Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) can study the IIT syllabus, as the premier Indian engineering institute has agreed to join MIT's OpenCourseWare community, thus finally becoming a part of the Open Education Resource Consortium. MIT students will now be able to access IIT content with a click of the mouse. The move would help IIT share open source tools for academic enhancement.

Other universities, including Yale, Peking, Harvard Law School, Notre Dame, Tufts, UC Irvine and Utah State have also allowed MIT to make their courses a part of the courseware. The Indian Institute of Management, Bengaluru, is also a member of MIT's OpenCourseWare.

UK schools to have open source in their IT curriculum

In what can be termed as a milestone, the UK government is planning to ditch the traditional curriculum in ICT, and adopt open source alternatives to assist students. The government thinks that such a change will accelerate digitisation in the economy.

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